

POE PART 1 OPSC6311
RESEARCH

Group members:

Kamohelo Simata ST10377205

Azwidali Manyaga ST10440560

Lusani Ramulifho ST10439607

Neo Entle Mokoena St10441962



Introduction

In daily life, handling one's personal finances is a crucial ability. Overspending and financial stress can result from people's inability to keep track of their earnings, outlays, and savings. With the proliferation of smartphones and digital technology, mobile budgeting apps have grown in popularity as tools that make it easier for people to keep an eye on their financial activity. With the help of these apps, users can track their spending, create budgets, examine their spending patterns, and improve their financial decisions (Chen, L. 2021).

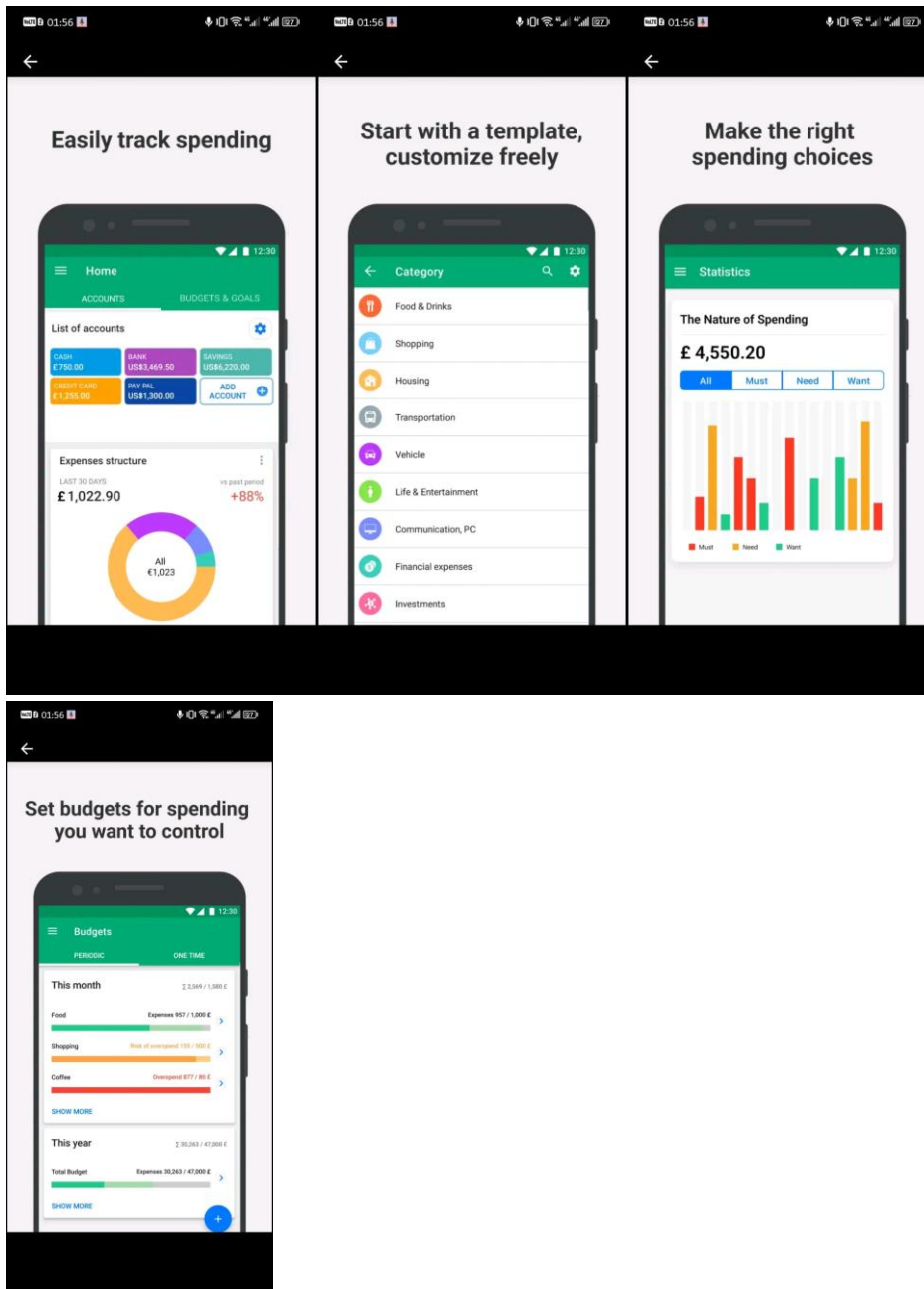
With features like financial reports, graphic graphs, and cost monitoring, budgeting applications offer a practical and effective method to handle money. Users may swiftly input expenses and examine their spending trends straight from their mobile devices, eliminating the need to manually enter transactions on paper. Advanced features like shared budgeting, bank account synchronization, and alerts that alert users when they are about to go over their budget are also included in certain applications (BudgetBakers. 2024).

This study aims to evaluate and contrast three widely used budgeting applications: **Spendee: Daily Budget Planner**, **Money Tracker: Expense & Budget**, and **Wallet: Budget & Money Manager**. The study will look at each application's characteristics, advantages, disadvantages, and cutting-edge tools. It is possible to determine the most beneficial aspects that may be incorporated into the creation of a new Android personal budgeting application by looking at these apps (BudgetBakers. 2024).

2.1 Overview of the Budgeting Applications (Wallet: Budget & Money Manager)

- **Wallet: Budget & Money Manager** is a personal finance application designed to help users track their income, expenses, and overall financial activities. The app allows individuals to organize their spending into categories such as groceries, transport, and entertainment, making it easier to monitor financial habits. The application also provides advanced budgeting tools that allow users to set financial goals and manage their budgets more effectively. One of the key features of the app is its ability to connect to bank accounts and automatically import transactions. This allows users to see their financial information in one place and analyze their spending through detailed reports and visual graphs (BudgetBakers. 2024).

SCREENSHOTS



2.2 Strengths and Weaknesses of the Application

Wallet: Budget & Money Manager Strengths

- Provides detailed financial tracking with graphs and reports
- Supports bank account synchronization for automatic transaction updates
- Allows multiple account and multi-currency management
- Cloud synchronization across devices

- Custom categories and budgets help users plan effectively

Weaknesses

- Some advanced features require a premium subscription
- Bank synchronization may not work with all financial institutions
- Certain functions require internet access, limiting offline usage

2.3 Innovative Features of the Applications

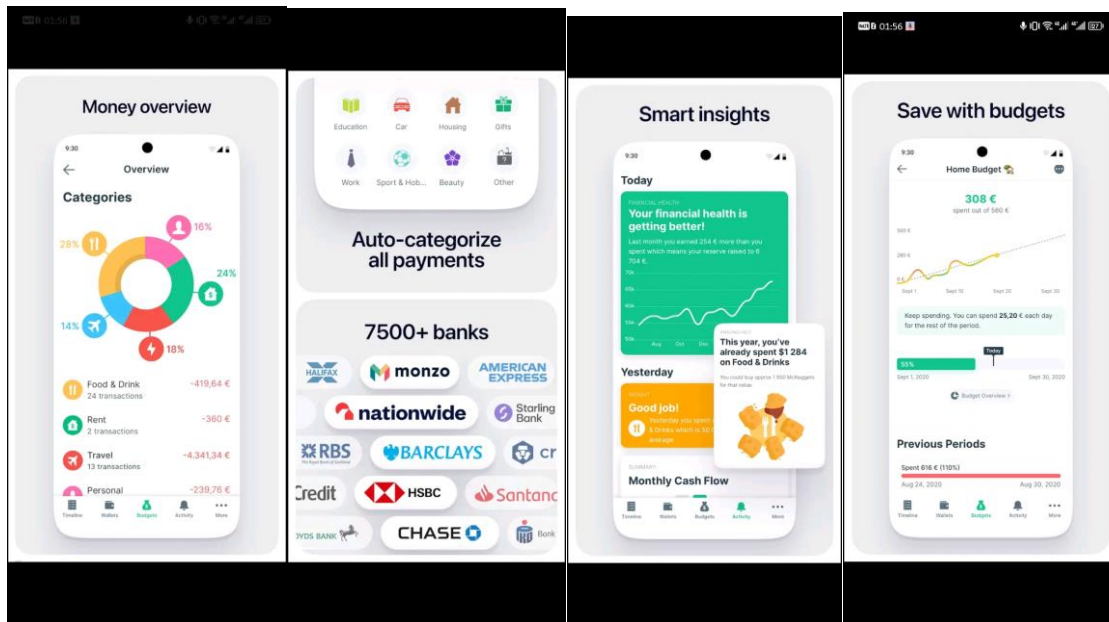
Innovation in budgeting apps can improve usability and motivate users to manage finances better. Each app introduces unique tools that differentiate it from the others:

- **Wallet: Budget & Money Manager**
 - Automatic transaction categorization using AI
 - Budget alerts to prevent overspending
 - Real-time financial insights
 - Cloud-based synchronization across multiple devices

2 Overview of the Budgeting Application (Spendee)

- **Spendee** is a budgeting application that helps users manage their personal finances by tracking expenses and planning budgets. The app provides a simple and visually appealing interface that allows users to quickly record transactions and monitor their spending habits. **Spendee** also provides visual dashboards and graphs that help users understand how their money is being spent across different categories. One of its unique features is the shared wallet option, which allows multiple users such as family members or partners to manage shared expenses together. This feature makes the application useful for both personal and collaborative budgeting (Spendee. 2024).

SCREENSHOTS



2.2 Strengths and Weaknesses of the Application

Spendee – Daily Budget Planner

Strengths

- Visually appealing interface with clear graphs and dashboards
- Shared wallet feature allows families or partners to track expenses together
- Supports multiple currencies for international users
- Provides notifications and reminders for budgets and bills

Weaknesses

- Advanced features require a paid subscription
- Bank synchronization is limited to supported institutions
- Internet connection is needed for certain functionalities

2.3 Innovative Features of the Applications

Innovation in budgeting apps can improve usability and motivate users to manage finances better. Each app introduces unique tools that differentiate it from the others:

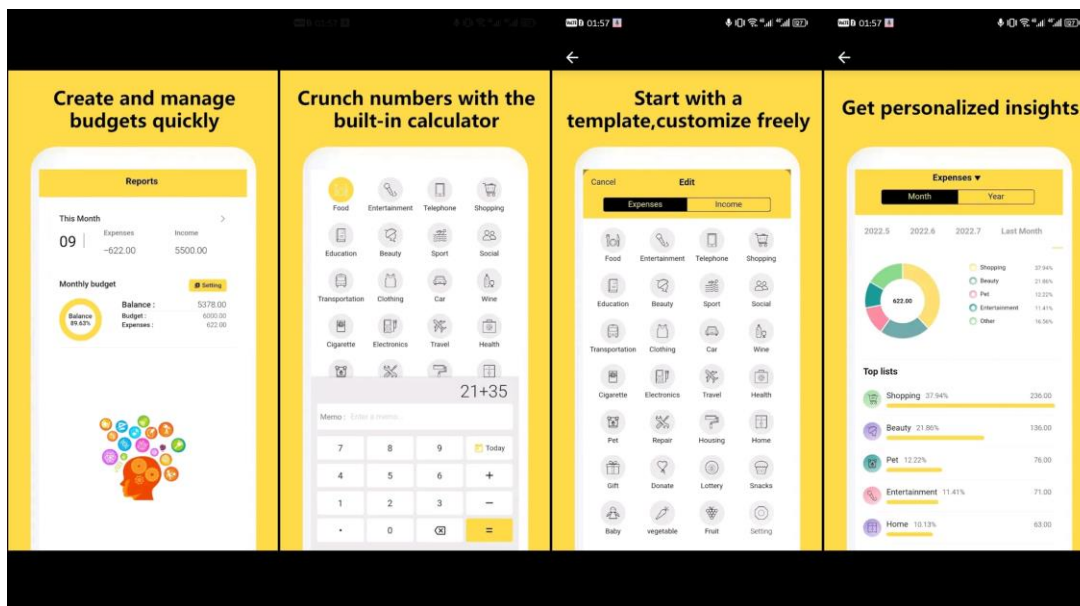
- **Spendee – Daily Budget Planner**
 - Shared wallet for collaborative budgeting
 - Smart visual dashboards for spending patterns
 - Notifications and alerts for budget limits

- Graphical financial analysis for better insights

Overview of the Budgeting Application (Money Tracker)

- **Money Tracker** is a financial management application designed to help users record and monitor their daily expenses. The app focuses on simplicity and allows users to manually enter transactions, organize them into categories, and view summaries of their spending. The application provides charts and reports that help users understand their financial behavior over time. Although it does not offer some advanced features such as bank synchronization, it is easy to use and suitable for individuals who want a straightforward tool to track their daily spending and maintain a basic budget (Realbyte. 2024.).

SCREENSHOTS



2.2 Strengths and Weaknesses of the Application

Money Tracker – Expense & Budget Strengths

- Simple and user-friendly interface suitable for beginners
- Quick manual expense entry with clear categorization
- Works offline with local data storage for privacy
- Visual reports for basic financial analysis

Weaknesses

- Lacks bank synchronization
- Limited advanced features for detailed financial management
- Basic reporting may not satisfy users needing in-depth insights

2.3 Innovative Features of the Applications

Innovation in budgeting apps can improve usability and motivate users to manage finances better. Each app introduces unique tools that differentiate it from the others:

- **Money Tracker – Expense & Budget**
 - Clean, minimal interface for fast expense entry
 - Offline data storage for privacy
 - Simple monthly summaries and charts for spending overview
 - Quick access to daily financial status

Although all three apps share common features such as expense tracking, budget planning, and visual reports, each introduces innovative tools tailored to specific user needs. Wallet focuses on advanced financial management, Spendee emphasizes shared and visual budgeting, and Money Tracker prioritizes simplicity and privacy.

3 Infographic image

Budgeting Apps Comparison

Wallet vs Spendee vs Money Tracker

	 Wallet	 Spendee	 Money Tracker
 Expense Tracking	✓	✓	✓
 Budget Planning	✓	✓	✓
 Graphs & Reports	✓	✓	✓
 Bank Sync	✓	✓	✗
 Shared Wallets	✗	✗	✓
 Multi-Currency	✓	✓	✗
 Offline Mode	✗	✗	✓
 Auto Categorization	✓	✓	✗
 Budget Alerts	✓	✓	✗



Best Features to Include in Your App

1 User system

- Register & Login – **basic email + password authentication**
- Profile – **optional: name and basic info**

2 Expense features

- Add Expense – **enter amount, category, date**
- Optional Description – **short note for each expense**
- Attach Receipt Photo – **camera or gallery (optional but simple with Android Intents)**

3 Budget Features

- Monthly Budget Limit – **set total monthly budget**
- Category Limits – **set limits for specific categories**
- Budget Alerts – **notify user when they approach/exceed limit**

4 Viewing Data

- View Expenses by Period – **daily, weekly, monthly**
- Category Totals – **show how much spent per category**
- Simple Graphs – **pie chart for category spending, bar chart for daily spending**

5 Storage

- Local Database – **use Room Database for saving expenses, categories, and budgets**
- Optional: **save photos in internal storage and link to expense record**

6 Dashboard

- Budget Progress – **show remaining budget and overspending alerts**
- Summary Cards – **total expenses, biggest category, remaining budget**

7 Gamification (Optional but Simple)

- Badges – **for staying under budget 3 days in a row, weekly streak**
- Streak Counter – **consecutive days of logging expenses**

Conclusion

After analyzing **Wallet: Budget & Money Manager**, **Spendee – Daily Budget Planner**, and **Money Tracker – Expense & Budget**, it is clear that each application provides valuable tools for managing personal finances, but they differ in complexity, design, and functionality. **Wallet** offers advanced financial management features such as bank synchronization, automatic categorization, and detailed reports, making it suitable for users who want a comprehensive overview of their finances. **Spendee** focuses on visual appeal and shared budgeting, which is ideal for families or couples who want to manage finances collaboratively. **Money Tracker** provides a simple, lightweight solution with offline storage, making it suitable for beginners or users who prefer privacy and straightforward expense tracking (OECD. 2023).

The research shows that the most important features to include in a personal budgeting app are: **expense tracking, budget planning, category management, visual graphs, and budget alerts**. Additional features such as receipt attachment, dashboard summaries, and simple gamification elements like badges or streaks can enhance user engagement and motivation.

By combining the strengths of these applications while keeping development manageable in Kotlin for Android Studio, it is possible to create a budgeting app that is both functional and user-friendly. The app should provide clear insights into spending habits, help users stay within their budget, and encourage consistent financial tracking, ultimately supporting better money management and financial awareness.

REFERENCE LIST

1. BudgetBakers. 2024. *Wallet app: Features and financial tracking tools*. Available at: <https://budgetbakers.com/> (Accessed: 12 March 2026).
2. Chen, L. 2021. *The impact of expense tracking on personal financial management*. Journal of Financial Technology, 5(2), pp. 45–60.
3. Figma 2026. Figma design tool. Available at: <https://www.figma.com> (Accessed: 23 March 2026).
4. Kumar, S. and Lim, H. 2022. *The role of mobile budgeting applications in improving financial behavior*. International Journal of Finance and Technology, 8(1), pp. 12–25.
5. OECD. 2023. *Financial literacy and consumer behavior: Insights and analysis*. Paris: OECD Publishing. Available at: <https://www.oecd.org/> (Accessed: 12 March 2026).

6. Realbyte. 2024. *Money Manager expense tracker application overview*. Available at: <https://www.realbyteapps.com/> (Accessed: 12 March 2026).
7. Statista. 2024. *Global usage of budgeting and financial management applications*. Available at: <https://www.statista.com/> (Accessed: 12 March 2026).
8. Spendee. 2024. *Spendee budgeting app features*. Available at: <https://www.spendee.com/> (Accessed: 12 March 2026).